

Short Guide to Ablution and Prayer ¹⁹⁸⁹

Every people have their own method of seeking comfort, relaxation and escape. Some use music, some use exercises like Yoga, and others drugs and alcohol. As for Muslims, we attain the benefits of all of the above and more, from Prayer. We resort to the source of all solutions and the source of all peace and relief - *Our Beloved, Our Creator*.

Every one of us was created with particular needs; like the need to feel loved, the need to be alone for a while, the need to know that someone special awaits you at home after a long hard day at work, the need to spend time with your children and kiss them to sleep, the need to hear nice words, etc. When these needs go unsatisfied, an imbalance occurs within us that can affect the quality of our entire day. We might become irritable and cranky and not know why. A need within us has not been met that day. Yet we have been created with a need far greater and more critical for our complete well-being than any other...It is the need *to worship*.

To satisfy this need, people through the ages have worshiped everything under the sun [and including the sun]. They worshiped idols, water, animals, snakes, the sun, the stars and money - exhausting great efforts and wealth to do so. Indeed, this need to worship must be satisfied, but none of the above can satisfy it like worshiping the One True God! And Prayer fulfills that satisfaction.

It was common that when the time for prayer came, the Prophet Muhammad would turn to Bilal [whose duty was to call out the call to prayer] and say, "*Relieve us with it, O Bilal!*" In other words, make the call, Bilal, for what will lighten our heavy burdens and will soothe and comfort us. For when the Prophet was troubled with a difficult matter or much worry, he would turn to prayer.

When the Prophet was facing his toughest time in Makkah, feeling the deepest sadness, how did God console him and lift his spirits? He *raised* the Prophet *to Him* during the most momentous event of all time – al-Israa wal-Mi'raaj! [the night journey to Jerusalem and then to the Heaven] till he reached the closest a man can ever reach in nearness to his Lord! It was on this occasion where God obligated the prayer to be performed five times a day.

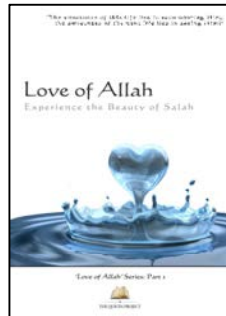
When we die, Prayer is the first responsibility we will be judged for, if it is sound [accepted], then all our deeds after it will be sound [accepted] and if it is corrupt, then all our deeds after it will be corrupt. The Prophet Muhammad said, "*whoever abandons it [prayer], has disbelieved.*"

However, it is not only the Prayer's obligatory nature that should compel us to tend to it. This would be an incomplete intention. The prayer is an act that brings such a satisfying comfort, a true quenching of that spiritual thirst! Your body maybe on earth, but your soul is floating around The Most Merciful's Throne! Prayer is God's greatest gift to us. In it is the peace and true happiness that we all yearn and search for. Every position has a special meaning and a unique significance, so that with every position we move to, we are transported into a new and different scene. These transitions help our *minds* to stay aware of and internalize the words we utter. These

¹⁹⁸⁹ Edited from various sources including, 'Love of Allāh' – www.quranproject.org and www.myprayer.org.au.

transitions help our *hearts* to stay alive throughout our Prayer - alive with alternating feelings and emotions before God; those of love, hope, fear, and humility.

Finally remember this: The sweetness of this life lies in *remembering* Him, the sweetness of the next life lies in *seeing* Him! when you proceed for prayer, go because you *love Him*, go because you *miss Him* and long to be with Him. Feel your heart flutter. Only then, will you be on your way to attaining that inner peace and comfort Prayer was prescribed for.



Source: Edited from 'Love of Allāh: Experience the beauty of Salah' – [available for free in PDF and book – order: www.quranproject.org]

Guide to Ablution and Prayer

This is a quick and basic guide to prayer which highlights the main pillars of prayer and ablution. For a more detailed and thorough guide to the rules/methods of prayer, logon to www.quranproject.org/prayer

Wudu – The Ablution

The Wudu is a pre-requisite for the prayer

1. Make intention for the ablution and say, 'Bismillah' (In the name of God)
2. Wash your hands
3. Rinse your mouth and nose
4. Wash the face
5. Wash the right arm including hand up to the elbow, then do the same for the left
6. Wipe the head back and forth once
7. Wash the right foot including its ankle, then do the same for the left

All actions of washing can be done once, twice or thrice except for wiping of the head which is done only once.

The Five Daily Prayers

For timings of each prayer, visit your local mosque and obtain a prayer timetable or visit www.salahtimes.com

<i>Name</i>	<i>Time of Day</i>	<i>Units of Prayer</i>
Fajr	Dawn	2
Dhuhr	Midday	4
Asr	Late-Afternoon	4
Maghrib	Sunset	3
Isha	Night	4

Note

Any part of what you find difficult to memorise you can replace with a supplication in your mother tongue like, ‘Glory be to Allāh, All praise is due to Allāh, Allāh is the Greatest and there is no deity worthy of worship except Allāh.’ Until you can memorise it in Arabic.

Short Phrases Translated

Moving in Prayer - ‘*Allāh u Akbar*’ – God is the Greatest

Bowing - ‘*Subhana rabbiyal Adheem*’ – Glory be to God the most Magnificent

After Bowing while Standing - ‘*Sami Allāhu liman hamidah*’ – God hears those who praise Him
- ‘*Rabbana wa lakal hamd*.’ Our Lord to You belong all the praise

While Prostrating - ‘*Subhana Rabbiyal a’la*’ – Glory be to God, Most High

In between Prostrations - ‘*Rabbigh firli war hamni.*’ - My Lord forgive me and have mercy on me

Completing the Prayer - ‘*Assalam alaykum wa rahmatullah*’ – May the Peace and Mercy of God be upon you

The first unit of Prayer (rak'ah)

In a standing position, face the Qiblah (prayer direction)



Note: The Qiblah is approx. South East for the UK, but changes according to your location in the world



.....And make the intention in your heart to pray that particular prayer.

1. Raise your hands up to the level of your shoulders/ face saying, 'Allah u Akbar'



2. Then place them on your chest, the right hand on the left.



3. Whilst standing recite the opening chapter (al-Fātihah) of the Qur'ān:

Bismillahi Rahmani Raheem
Alhamdu lillahi Rabbil alameen.
Ar-Rahmanir Raheem.
Maliki Yawmid deen.
Iyyaka na'budu wa
iyyaka nasta'een.
Ihdinas siratal mustaqeem.
Siratal latheena an'amta alayhim.
Ghayril maghdubi alayhim walad
daalleen.'

Then say: 'Ameen'

'In the name of God, the Most Compassionate, the Most Merciful.

All praise be to God, Lord of the worlds,
The Most Compassionate, the Most Merciful,
Master of the Day of Judgment.
It is You [alone] we worship and
You [alone] we ask for help.
Guide us to the straight path
The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favour,
not of those who have evoked [Your] anger or of those who
are astray.'

4. Say '*Allāh u Akbar*' then bow down. Then say '*Subhana rabbiyal Adheem*' three times, while bowing down



5. Return to a standing position saying, '*Sami Allāhu liman hamidah, Rabbana wa lakal hamd.*'



6. Say '*Allāh u Akbar*' and prostrate yourself with the forehead and the nose touching the ground and say while prostrating '*Subhana Rabbiyal a'la*' three times...



7. Sit up saying '*Allāhu Akbar*' then say while seated '*Rabbigh firli war hammi.*'



8. Prostrate yourself again saying '*Allāhu Akbar*' and repeat the same supplication '*Subhana Rabbiyal a'la.*'



The second unit of Prayer (rak'ah)

Return to a standing position for the second unit of prayer (rak'ah) saying 'Allāhu Akbar.'
Start with reading the opening chapter and continue this unit of prayer as you did in the first.

At-Tashahhud (The Testimony)

9. In the three or four unit prayer, after the second unit, sit down after your prostration and say the following supplication



'At-tahiyyatu lillahi was-salawatu wattayyibat. Assalamu alayka ayyahun nabiyyu wa rahmatul-lahi wa barakatahuh. Assalamu alayna wa ala ibadillahis saliheen. Ashhadu alla ilaha ilal-ha wa ashadu anna Muhammadan abduhu wa rasuluh.

'Words of Praise and glorification are for Allāh and Prayers and pure words. Peace and salutations upon you O Prophet and the Mercy of Allāh and His Blessings. And peace be upon us and upon all of Allāh's righteous servants. I testify that none has the right to be worshipped except Allāh and testify that Muhammad is His Slave and Messenger.'

10. In the final rak'ah (unit prayer) say the previous (point 9) supplication and add the following supplication:

'Allāhumma salli 'ala Muhammad wa 'ala ali Muhammad kama sallayta ala Ibraheem wa 'ala ali Ibraheem innaka hameedun majeed. Allāhumma barik 'ala Muhammad wa 'ala Muhammad kama barakta 'ala Ibraheem wa 'ala ali Ibraheem innaka hameedun majeed'

'O Lord, bless Muhammad and his family as You blessed Ibrahim and his family. You are the Most-Praised, The Most Glorious. O Lord, bestow Your grace on Muhammad and his family as You bestowed it on Ibrahim and his family. You are the Most-Praised, the Most-Glorious.'

11. After you say the supplication turn your face right saying

'Assalam alaykum wa rahmatullah'.....

....Then turn left saying the same.



Now your Prayer is complete

